religion and introduced the worship of the Aten. Historians believe that it was they who introduced the world's first monotheistic religion. The religious reforms Akhenaten introduced to the country meant that the priests no longer held any real power. The pharaoh went against the old traditions once again when he transferred the capital to a new site at Amarna. This period is referred to as the Amarna Period and dates between 1,353 and 1,336 BCE where the worship of the old gods was abolished.

The new religious beliefs were not that popular with the Egyptian people. Akhenaten became famous for his beautiful temple in which he constructed a statue in dedication to Nefertiti. As his government progressed, he was not able to meet the demands of the people. Historians believe this happened because Akhenaten focused his attention more on religious beliefs than the welfare of the people.

After his death, his son was named pharaoh. He was originally named Tutankhaten but he was renamed Tutankhamun upon his coronation. He ruled between 1,336 to 1,327 BCE and brought back the worship of the old gods. He restored the old temples and attempted to remove all mention of his father's god. The capital was moved back to Thebes before he died at age 18 or 19. He is famous for his tomb that was discovered in the 1920s by Howard Carter. His death has sparked numerous theories as to whether he died from natural causes or whether he was murdered by his successor.

Ramesses II is also referred to as Ramesses the Great and considered to be the greatest pharaoh to have lived during the New Kingdom Period. He fathered over 100 children and created some of the most extravagant buildings the country had ever known. He ultimately led the Egyptians in the Battle of Kadesh against Muwatalli II of the Hittite Empire. The result was technically a draw but Ramesses II had himself depicted as the great Egyptian hero on public displays. Indeed, he commissioned a beautiful depiction of the battle and himself leading the Egyptians to victory on the walls of the temple at Abu Simbel. As with Akhenaten, he dedicated a temple to his beautiful queen Nefertari. In 1,258 BCE, he signed the Treaty of Kadesh, which is basically the first peace treaty in history. He ruled until